

CANDIDATE’S NAME.....

SIGNATURE.....

P310/1

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

Paper 1

3 Hours

2026

Personal number



**Apex Examination
Council**

UGANDA ADVANCED CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION

PRE-MOCK EXAMINATIONS 2026

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

PAPER 1

(Critiquing Literary Works)

Time: 3 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

This paper consists of two sections, A and B.

Section A is compulsory.

Section B has four essay questions. Answer only two.

Answer three questions in all.

Credit will be given for critical analysis, literary appreciation, relevant illustration and clarity of expression.

SECTION A

1. Read the passage below and answer the tasks that follow.

The village of Kanyegaramire had never witnessed a gathering as large as the one that assembled on the afternoon of 18th August 2023. The burial ceremony of Mzee Baryamureeba, a respected retired head teacher and community elder, had attracted mourners from different parts of western Uganda. Former students, religious leaders, local government officials and relatives filled the compound. Large tents had been erected to shelter guests, while choirs from neighbouring churches took turns singing hymns in honour of the deceased.

As the ceremony progressed, speakers rose one after another to celebrate the old man's contribution to education and community development. Many described him as a disciplinarian who had transformed the lives of countless young people. The atmosphere was both sorrowful and celebratory; people mourned his death while expressing gratitude for the legacy he had left behind.

Shortly before sunset, a cultural troupe began performing traditional dances. The drumming intensified, and the crowd formed a wide circle around the dancers. Some elders joined the performance, recalling customs that had been practised for generations. Excitement spread through the gathering as spectators cheered and recorded videos on their mobile phones.

At the height of the celebrations, a licensed security officer attached to a private security company fired several shots into the air as a symbolic salute to the deceased. The crowd initially applauded. However, moments later, panic erupted. One of the bullets had ricocheted from a nearby metallic structure and struck a university student who had been standing among the spectators. The young man collapsed instantly.

The music stopped. Conversations faded into silence. Family members rushed toward the victim as others called emergency services. Despite efforts by medical personnel who arrived at the scene, the student was pronounced dead on arrival at the district hospital.

News of the incident spread rapidly across social media platforms and local radio stations. Public debate soon emerged. Some community members argued that the officer should face severe criminal charges because his negligence had led to the loss of innocent life. Others maintained that the death was accidental and that punishment should consider the circumstances surrounding the incident.

Several weeks later, the matter was brought before court. Legal experts, religious leaders and cultural authorities expressed differing opinions about justice, responsibility and reconciliation. The case raised important questions about the balance between cultural practices, public safety and the law in contemporary society.

TASKS

(a) The death of the student sparks debate about justice, responsibility and punishment in contemporary society. Write an argumentative response giving your opinion on the action that should be taken against the security officer.

(b) Examine the ways in which the writer creates mood and atmosphere in the passage.

SECTION B

Either

2. Literature presents human relationships as complex experiences that can inspire growth, promote unity or generate conflict. Through interactions among family members, friends, lovers, leaders and followers, writers reveal important truths about human behaviour and society.

Referring to any drama text you have studied, discuss how relationships among characters contribute to your understanding of human nature and society.

Or

3. Many literary works suggest that success and failure are influenced by both personal choices and external forces. Characters often struggle between individual responsibility, social pressures, fate and circumstances beyond their control.

Drawing illustrations from any drama text you have studied, examine the extent to which the protagonist's downfall results from personal weaknesses and external forces.

Either

4. A literature student observes that memories of the past often help readers understand a character's present behaviour. He further notes that writers carefully choose narrative voices and flashbacks to reveal hidden experiences that shape characters and influence events.

Using any novel you have studied, discuss how flashbacks and narrative voice contribute to character portrayal and the reader's understanding of the novel.

Or

5. During a literary symposium at a university, participants discuss why some novels remain memorable long after they have been read. One speaker argues that effective storytelling techniques such as suspense, foreshadowing, conflict, pacing and plot organisation keep readers engaged from beginning to end.

Referring to any novel you have studied, assess the contribution of storytelling techniques to your understanding and appreciation of the novel.

END